

Talking about it

If teens are feeling overwhelmed, and negative thoughts are hard to escape, checking in with a friend or parent and talking about how they feel can help. An outside perspective can help a person see that they're actually managing a situation better than they think. Keeping in mind the positive comments made by friends or parents can make a big difference the next time things are feeling difficult.

▷ Not alone

It can be hard to open up about feeling sad or low, but talking about it with someone else usually helps put things in perspective.



Build positive relationships

Supportive friends can give a person confidence, and push them to meet their potential. Good friends reinforce a person's positive thoughts, celebrate each other's achievements, and offer support in hard times, which can be invaluable to a person's inner well-being.

Help others

Helping friends and noticing their needs can help people feel good about themselves and their friendship.

Be kind to yourself

People are often kinder to others than they are to themselves. Self-talk is the way people speak to themselves. While people tend to find it easier to believe negative things about themselves, it is important that teens catch any negative self-talk and replace it instead with more positive and compassionate thoughts. This will help a person to feel confident and in control.

Learn new skills

Developing skills outside of a teen's comfort zone can test and develop their resilience, as well as give them a chance to meet and become friends with new and different people.

Stay active

Exercise releases endorphins—the body's natural mood elevator—benefiting both body and mind.

Meditate

People have used meditation for thousands of years as a way to manage thoughts and feelings, and to relax a busy mind. It is similar to mindfulness, but uses different methods to encourage feelings of calm.

Set goals and ambitions

Having goals—big or small—focuses the mind on a task. Staying on track and focused when working toward a goal is an important part of building resilience. Hard work and setbacks are part of the journey and make successes even sweeter.

Relax

Whether it's watching a new film, listening to a favorite band, or reading a book, making time for oneself to relax and just "be" is important for well-being.